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AI 2010 Final Project: Brand-In-a-Box

Brand-In-a-Box came about because I saw this problem: that many small businesses don't have an established brand or an established social media presence and I produced the solution to that. Social media has transformed the marketing space, and it is essential for small businesses. Without a good social media presence, small businesses have no way to get the word out about where they are going to be. This leaves them to completely rely on word of mouth. Brand-In-a-Box provides essential value to every small business owner struggling to secure social media presence. Many small businesses offer five-star products and deserve to have a social media presence that matches and that's what Brand-In-a-Box provides.

This project applies to my major in many ways. The reason this idea came about was because of the social media and marketing internship this past summer. My boss, Dylan, was struggling to find time and resources to put into social media for his business, UniMovers Des Moines. He took me on as a social media and marketing intern, and when I interviewed him about the work I did for him this summer, he said this "[Outsourcing marketing help allows me to] do moves, answer the phone, book movers, and find time to work on the company itself". This is how the idea for Brand-In-a-Box was born. I wanted to be able to create something that helped small business owners who felt stuck when it came to social media marketing. I am a Marketing and Entrepreneurship major, so this project idea perfectly fits with my major. Not only am I drafting my own idea, but I am also helping fellow entrepreneurs with their marketing.

As I mentioned above, Brand-In-a-Box's main objective is to provide premium marketing services to small businesses struggling to find the time or resources to do well in social media marketing. The main objective of Brand-In-a-Box is made up by multiple objectives that are based on the problems and pains of business owners. Brand-In-a-Box helps bring the five-star marketing quality to businesses that offer five-star products and deserve better marketing. Brand-In-a-Box can free up way more time for business owners to do what they are best at, managing their business. Before I worked for UniMovers Dylan said this about his marketing process, "I was spending an hour on each post going over every detail trying to make it perfect. That was dumb and neurotic." Social media marketing is a very big pain for business owners that takes too much time and distracts them from running their business. This is the problem that Brand-In-a-Box solves.

Creating this idea into a Gemini Chatbot was relatively straightforward after getting all these details about Brand-In-a-Box on paper. I was able to use a couple files about Brand-In-a-Box that I had created in my entrepreneurship class and plug it into a Gemini Gem. I then worked with Gemini and built strong instructions for the Gem to follow. I did this by explaining what I specifically wanted the Gem to do and the personality and job I wanted it to take on. I wanted to make sure the chatbot had a firm identity and purpose so I wouldn't get back answers that were too general.

After using Gemini to help me draft detailed instructions I landed on this: "You are a busy business owner's marketing best friend. Business owners will upload what their business does, their mission statements, and statistics from their social media platforms. You will take that data and give the business owner a specific brand image (fonts, colors, templates), custom buyer

personas, and market audience. You can base this on what has worked for other businesses in the market that they are in, and what is working marketing-wise at that time.” This allows the chatbot to be specific but also to help with any brand or business that gets thrown at it. It’s very important that it’s able to stay on mission and focused on helping the small business owner.

I then ended the instructions with questions that the chatbot can ask the business owner before it gets started tailoring a marketing plan for their business. The questions included: "Tell me about your business—what do you do, and who is your dream customer? If you have any statistics, they would be helpful here. How do you want people to perceive your business? What is your ideal brand image? What is the biggest struggle you currently face when posting to social media?" This helps the chatbot know exactly where the business owner is at with social media marketing, how much experience they have in it, and what specifically they need help with.

After plugging this and much more into the Gem, I was able to have a conversation with it that was very tailored and helpful. Since I work for UniMovers, I used them as my example. The Gem was able to take UniMover’s social media data and give me a specific audience and a specific geographical spot that I should be targeting. It also gave me back what colors and themes I should be using to best represent UniMovers, what the ideal brand voice for UniMovers is, and the strategy I should use when preparing and posting for UniMovers.

Overall, I was very pleased with the results I got back from my Brand-In-a-Box Chatbot and would really love to continue to do more work with the idea of Brand-In-a-Box. I believe that this idea is one that is wanted and needed by small business owners. Based off the interviews that I did in my entrepreneurship class social media marketing is a big pain point for small business owners and is something that they need guidance on. By consolidating Brand-In-a-Box

into an AI chatbot it allows me to take all the knowledge and expertise of a marketing specialist and outsource it to AI.

I could see Brand-In-a-Box becoming an all-encompassing app specific to business that need help marketing. Right now, there is nowhere where you can do all your marketing and posting for social media in one spot. It takes multiple applications to run. If Brand-In-a-Box was put into an app it could fill that gap by providing an AI marketing specialist and the ability to upload pictures and have it help you caption, brand, and schedule a social media post all in one app. I believe that not only is this a helpful tool for me working for UniMovers but is also a viable business option for the future.